



WIRELESS HOME AUDIO SYSTEMS

Are you ready to spend extra to get rid of the cables running across your room to the rear surround-sound speakers? If yes, go for an add-on unit for wireless transmission of audio signals to the speakers. If you don't own a home theatre system and are planning to buy one, you can buy an integrated home theatre system with wireless rear speakers

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Wireless audio systems are designed for streaming music wirelessly across your living room. Some may let you enjoy music from your computer or other audio source anywhere around your house. Wireless speakers are generally more compact than their wired counterparts. These have built-in antennae and don't require additional connections.

Notwithstanding their advantages, if we go by the market feedback, sales of wireless home audio systems have not picked up owing to their high cost. These can cost about Rs 16,000 more than their wired counterparts. That's why you'll find only a few models of wireless home audio systems in electronics stores.

But, still there is a niche segment

of consumers that doesn't want to compromise on the aesthetics of their living room due to the clutter of wires running around the room. They also get the added flexibility and convenience of not having to run wires across the room to the rear speakers.

Wireless home audio systems are offered by companies like Bose, Philips, Sony, Panasonic, Samsung and Logitech. Take a look at what's available in the market.

Types available

Wireless home audio systems can either be add-on units or integrated home theatre systems with wireless speakers. Usually, these wirelessly transmit audio signals to the remotely placed speakers over RF link in the 2.4GHz band. There are also units making use of the 5.8GHz band. Though these work over shorter range, they are less prone to interference from house-

hold appliances like microwave ovens and your mobile phone operating in 900MHz or 2.4GHz band. Nor do they interfere with the wireless network for Internet access within or around your house as most WLANs use the 2.4GHz band. RF doesn't require line of sight, so you can hide away the transmitter and receiver units.

Some systems may use infrared link for communication, but these support short distances within the same room as they require line of sight between the transmitter and the receiver.

Add-ons. An add-on type wireless home audio system is basically a combination of a wireless transmitter-receiver pair and speaker system. The wireless transmitter connects to your audio/video source like DVD player, the speakers including centre channel, front right and front left, and power supply. The receiver, kept at the other end of the room, connects to the rear